

Rental Application Fast-Track Checklist — South Australia

Win the lease, even with no rental history or connections.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice. SA's rental laws changed significantly from 1 July 2024 — this checklist reflects the current framework.

Section 1 — Know Your Rights Before You Apply

- ☐ [] **Know your tenancy is governed by the Residential Tenancies Act 1995 (SA)**, following major reforms from 1 July 2024 — described by the SA Government as the biggest changes to the state's rental laws in a generation.
- ☐ [] **Know rent bidding is banned**. Landlords and agents cannot solicit or accept offers above the advertised rent — this protection has been in place since April 2023.
- ☐ [] **Know the prescribed forms changed again on 1 September 2025** — if anyone hands you outdated forms, that's a sign to double-check compliance with current requirements.

Section 2 — Documents to Have Ready

- ☐ [] **Photo ID** (driver's licence or passport).
- ☐ [] **Proof of income** — payslips, employment letter, or for students/first-time renters: Centrelink statements, scholarship confirmation, or guarantor documents.
- ☐ [] **Rental history/references** — previous landlord/agent details, or alternative references if you're a first-time renter.
- ☐ [] **Bank statements**, if requested.

Section 3 — The Application Itself

- ☐ [] **Apply promptly after inspecting** — Adelaide's rental market has experienced record low vacancy rates, so competitive properties move fast.
- ☐ [] **Attend the inspection in person if possible**.
- ☐ [] **Follow up politely, once**, if you haven't heard back within a few days.
- ☐ [] **If you have a pet, know your position is genuinely improved since 2024** — for the first time, SA tenants can have pets in rental homes, subject to landlord approval and reasonable conditions (e.g. keeping the animal outside, or professional carpet cleaning at lease end).

Section 4 — For Students & First-Time Renters Specifically

- ☐ [] **Consider a guarantor** if you lack independent rental/income history — confirm the specific agency genuinely accepts this.
- ☐ [] **Highlight stability signals** — enrolment confirmation, course length, stable casual work history.
- ☐ [] **Consider co-applying with reliable housemates** for a stronger combined application.
- ☐ [] **Don't be discouraged by rejections** in a competitive market — apply for multiple properties in parallel.

Section 5 — Know Your Ongoing Protections Once You're In

- ☐ [] **Know no-grounds terminations were abolished from 1 July 2024** — your landlord needs a valid, documented reason to end your tenancy from day one.
- ☐ [] **Know rent can only be increased once every 12 months**, with 60 days' notice.

Quick Reference — Key SA Rental Application Rules

RULE	DETAIL
Rent bidding	Banned since April 2023
No-grounds evictions	Abolished since 1 July 2024
Pets	Permitted subject to landlord approval and reasonable conditions, since 1 July 2024
Rent increase	Once per 12 months, 60 days' notice
Dispute resolution	South Australian Civil and Administrative Tribunal (SACAT)

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